options like marking read and ignoring etc can be accomplished from the context menu.

Configuration



4D's nit-picking options

All the configure options are accessible under the Settings menu. The General Settings link offers the options to configure the client. The range of configurable options is daunting, it could easily satisfy someone obsessed with tweaking an interface. The less confusing options relate to setting the text colour and font styles for the messages and interface.

The layout is modifiable from the layout option. A lot of possibilities are presented for you to choose from. Besides changing the shape of the panes, the content in each also can be changed.

The Servers, Identities and Signatures link allows you to set a signature that is appended to all posts. If needed alternative identities can be created, if only to avoid spamming when posting to NGs. The main identity can be used for e-mail purposes. Additional NNTP serves can also be configured here.

Under the Configure Buttons and Shortcuts link the button placement and selection on the toolbars can be modified. It needs to be noted that the interface, though loaded with buttons has them in the wrong place. The context menu in 4D is mostly cosmetic, since the truly useful and much repeated actions can be managed only by accessing the buttons on the toolbar. This makes for a lot of scrolling back and forth, which is an irritant.

The Glossary can be used to create word associations so that typing a code will result in the much larger phrase being pasted automatically. The level of automation can also be taken up a notch by the inbuilt scripting support, accessible from the Scripting link. Frequent actions can be scripted, and the scripts can be launched by certain events. The comprehensive help file that is included has a list of all commands and events that can be used for scripting.